

Date	2024-01-30	Time	10:00–16:30
Location	Plastex GmbH head office, Industriestraße 44, Munich	Ref.	CRC-PLASTEX-2024-01
Customer	Plastex GmbH	Type	Annual sales visit

ATTENDEES

Name	Company	Role
Mr Pierre Valentin	ChemCorp Industries S.A.	Sales Director
Ms Sophie Durand	ChemCorp Industries S.A.	Key Account Manager DACH
Dr. Martine Chabrol	ChemCorp Industries S.A.	R&D Director (present in the afternoon)
Dr. Klaus Weber	Plastex GmbH	Purchasing Director
Ms Anna Krüger	Plastex GmbH	Supply Manager
Mr Thomas Bauer	Plastex GmbH	Head of R&D, Plastex
Ms Lena Schreiber	Plastex GmbH	Quality Manager

BACKGROUND

Customer profile: Manufacturer of technical plastic parts (polycarbonate, ABS, POM) for the automotive and electronics industries. 2023 revenue: approx. €180M. Main purchases from ChemCorp: acetone (1,200 t/year), toluene (400 t/year), isopropyl alcohol (300 t/year).

Meeting context: Annual review of the partnership. The current framework contract expires on 2024-12-31. In 2023 Plastex launched a "Green Manufacturing" initiative imposing sustainability criteria on its suppliers.

PROCEEDINGS

1. 2023 review and customer satisfaction

Dr. Weber opened the meeting and presented the 2023 purchasing review: volumes delivered were in line with forecast (acetone 1,187 t, toluene 398 t, IPA 312 t). ChemCorp service rate: 96.8% (Plastex target: 97%). A delivery delay in August (acetone, week 33) caused a 4h line stoppage; the internal cost was estimated by Ms Krüger at €12k. Ms Schreiber (Quality) was satisfied with the certificates of analysis but raised 2 non-conformities: batch ACK-230814 (acetone): APHA colour 15 against a specification of 10 max — accepted under concession but to be avoided; batch IPA-231102 (IPA): water content 0.23% against 0.20% max — batch rejected and replaced at no extra cost. Mr Valentin presented the ChemCorp indicators: customer satisfaction score 7.8/10 (annual survey), complaints resolved in 5 days on average. He set out the 2024 improvements: a new customer platform for real-time delivery tracking, and automatic alerts 3 days before delivery.

2. Commercial terms for the 2025 framework contract

Mr Valentin presented the ChemCorp proposal for the 2025 framework contract: committed volumes of acetone 1,300 t (+9%), toluene 400 t (flat), IPA 320 t (+3%). Pricing: indexed monthly to the IHS Markit Chemical Price Index plus a fixed contractual margin. Progressive volume discount: -1.5% from 1,200 t, -3% above 1,500 t of acetone. Dr. Weber asked whether ChemCorp could absorb late delivery penalties: Mr Valentin proposed 0.05% of the value of the delivery concerned per day of delay, capped at 5%. Dr. Weber counter-proposed 0.1% — a compromise at 0.08% was accepted in the meeting.

Ms Krüger asked about the possibility of urgent partial deliveries within 48h (instead of 5 days): Mr Valentin confirmed this is feasible for volumes below 5 t from the Limonest depot (permanent safety stock confirmed by Ms Marchand by email). Urgency surcharge: +8% on the contract price.

3. Plastex Green Manufacturing initiative

Ms Krüger presented the new Plastex CSR requirements for Tier-1 suppliers (applicable from January 2025): a minimum Carbon Disclosure Project (CDP) score of B, an annual sustainability report aligned with GRI, and documented traceability of renewable raw materials.

Dr. Chabrol (arrived at 14:00) presented the ChemCorp Green Chemistry programme: the BioSolv range under development (limonene, lactic esters), ISCC+ certification in progress, and an annual ESG report published since 2022 (current CDP score: C+ — with a plan to reach B by 2025).

Mr Bauer (R&D Plastex) expressed strong interest in a bio-based version of ethyl acetate for plastic paint formulations. Dr. Chabrol proposed a co-development programme: supply of 500 kg of BioEster-1 prototype for testing in Q3 2024, with an NDA signed in the meeting (annex 1).

Plastex undertook to grant exclusivity in principle (without firm commitment) for 18 months if the test results are satisfactory and if ChemCorp can deliver 50 t/year at nominal rate.

4. Visit to the Plastex production site

Afternoon: a tour of the injection moulding and extrusion workshops. Mr Valentin identified an unaddressed opportunity: Plastex uses DMF (dimethylformamide) from a third-party supplier for certain polishing applications. Volume: approx. 80 t/year. Ms Durand will send a competitive offer with a full SDS within 2 weeks.

Ms Schreiber showed the quality control room: ChemCorp needs to align with the Plastex analytical methods for 4 parameters (colorimetry, evaporation residue, acidity, miscibility). An inter-laboratory correlation plan was proposed by Ms Schreiber — Dr. Chabrol accepted and appointed Mr Lecomte as technical contact.

Minutes CRC-PLASTEX-2024-01 — Opportunities & action plan

IDENTIFIED OPPORTUNITIES

Opportunity	Context	Likelihood	Next step
DMF 80 t/year	New product — currently third-party supplier	High	Ms Durand — offer within 15 days
BioEster-1 prototype	Bio-based co-development	Very high	Dr. Chabrol — Q3 2024 programme
IPA extension 2025	Volume +3% framework contract	Confirmed	Mr Valentin — contract being drafted

ACTION PLAN

ChemCorp owner	Action	Due date
Mr Valentin	Draft and send the 2025 framework contract proposal	2024-02-15
Ms Durand	Send a competitive DMF offer for 80 t/year + SDS	2024-02-14
Dr. Chabrol	Schedule production of 500 kg BioEster-1 prototype + test protocol	2024-02-29
Mr Lecomte	Contact Ms Schreiber about the inter-laboratory correlation plan	2024-02-10
Ms Durand	Prepare the visit report for the CRM (Salesforce)	2024-02-02

Next contact: Monthly call on 2024-02-28, then framework contract review in March 2024.